EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 30 OCTOBER 2026

Afgooye, Lower Shabelle

The Shabelle floods first, through river breaks nobody has sealed. Diarrhoea and cholera follow among children who are already wasted, then the heat peaks in February and March. Seal the known breaks and get warnings to every camp now.

REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Shabeellaha Hoose (Lower Shabelle), province level	720 forecast, 630 of them January–March; 260 already past (Jun–Sep)	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027	Deyr river floods; cholera, diarrhoea, and measles among wasted children; Rift Valley fever risk; humid heat in February–March

15/15 recommendations checked. 8 of the 9 actions were corrected, 1 confirmed, none unverified; 6 contraindicated (the six "Do not do this" cards). All 8 For you steps were checked: 2 confirmed and 6 corrected. Two lens proposals were dropped in verification: WFP cereal pre-positioning (WFP ended in-kind food aid in April 2026) and a mobile-money fee waiver (EVC Plus is already free to send). Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review, methods forthcoming. It is published for the whole of Lower Shabelle, not for Afgooye, and it counts heat only. Afgooye's share was not calculated. The floods, and the disease that follows them, are not in this number. The river is high but falling at the nearest gauge: the Shabelle

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



2.14°N 45.12°E, Somalia · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** The 1997 El Niño Deyr floods killed about 2,000 people on the Juba and Shabelle; in 2023 Afgooye flooded from 4 October and 28,000 people were displaced with Mogadishu.
- **For you.** By 15 November, if you live in Baalguri, Aaytir, Raqeyle, Siigaale, Dhagahtuur, or Dambaley, agree where your family goes and move seed, stock, and papers to high ground.
- **The money.** US$210,000–1.95 million; cholera supplies and malnutrition treatment buy the most lives, and nobody has funded Afgooye yet.
- **Do not.** Do not hand food or cash through camp gatekeepers: a UN review found diversion at all 55 sites it examined.

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at Jowhar passed its 5.25 m high-risk level on 17 October and read 4.27 m on 30 October, while Belet Weyne upstream read 6.42 m against a 6.50 m moderate-risk level. Afgooye itself has no live gauge. No pre-arranged money was found that names Afgooye this season. The funding target fell by a fifth in verification, from US$718,000 to US$577,000, because the cash line was re-based on WFP's published transfer.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT

8 STEPS

For a family in Afgooye town, a riverside village, or one of the camps on the corridor, El Niño comes in waves. The Deyr rains now under way can push the Shabelle through its broken banks in November or December. Diarrhoea, cholera, and measles then kill more children than the water does, Rift Valley fever can follow in the animals from December, and the hottest, most humid weeks come in February and March. The ranked actions below are written for the district, South West State, and their partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

If you live in a riverside village that flooded in 2024, agree now where your family will go, and move seed, stock, and documents to higher ground

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTIONS 1 AND 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 November 2026	your own time	the household, animals, seed, and papers

Baalguri, Raqeyle, Aaytir, Siigaale, Dhagahtuur, and Dambaley all flooded in September 2024 and about 1,200 people were displaced (OCHA and iMMAP assessment). In July 2020 the river overtopped the sandbags and reached Aytire. Decide who carries the children and the old, and which building on high ground you go to, before the water comes.

Listen for river warnings on Radio Ergo and by phone, and keep a phone charged

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 2

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
now until the end of December	none	the household

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Radio Ergo broadcasts in Somali on shortwave 11875 kHz at 06:30 and 21595 kHz at 15:00 (Somali time). In the 2024 flood warnings, most warned households heard the warning as a phone ringback tone. You do not need to read the river gauges yourself; the danger signal is a warning that the river upstream at Belet Weyne or Jowhar is rising.

Keep oral rehydration salts (ORS) at home, start them at the first watery stool, and boil or chlorinate drinking water *

CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
now, through the floods	ORS is usually free at health posts during outbreaks; no local price was found	children under five

ORS prevents a large share of deaths from diarrhoea, up to 93% in an expert review (Munos 2010). In the 2024 cholera outbreak, Afgooye was named among the affected districts and 62% of Somalia's cholera deaths were children under five.

Have every child under five measured for malnutrition (a MUAC arm band check) at the nearest open nutrition site *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 November 2026	normally free; ask first which site is still open	children under five

FSNAU estimates that 15.4% of Afgooye's young children are acutely malnourished (Critical), about 12,250 of them severely. A wasted child is far more likely to die of cholera, measles, or heat. Many health and nutrition sites closed in 2026 for lack of funds, so ask the camp committee or a health worker which one is open.

Check every child's measles doses, and if a child catches measles, ask for vitamin A *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 November 2026	normally free at MCH clinics	children

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

One measles dose is about 85% protective, and two or more doses of vitamin A cut measles deaths by about 62% (Sudfeld 2010). National campaigns ran in May 2025 and April 2026, but children who arrived in Afgooye since then may have been missed.

If you are a woman, register a SIM card in your own name so cash aid reaches you directly

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
before any cash round, ideally November 2026	cost of a SIM; registration fee not confirmed	the household's food money

Aid case studies in Somalia found that women given a SIM sometimes had the phone kept by a man in the household. SIM registration is mandated through the National Communications Authority and accepts a passport, an immigration ID, a birth certificate, or a guarantor.

From December to February, if animals abort or fall sick, wear gloves when handling them, and cook all meat, milk, and blood *

CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 9

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
December 2026 – February 2027	none	herders and the family

Rift Valley fever followed the 1997 El Niño floods and the 2006 floods in southern Somalia, 6 to 10 weeks after the water. In August 2026, IGAD and FAO named Somalia among countries at raised risk. Abortions in livestock are the warning sign; report them to the district or a veterinary worker.*

In January–March, rest in shade at midday, keep stored water covered, and check daily on wasted children and older neighbours *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 8

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
January – March 2027	none	children, older people, and the sick

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The heat forecast for Lower Shabelle peaks in February and March. It is humid heat with warm nights rather than extreme daytime peaks, and most shelters have no electricity, so shade, water, and checking on the weakest matter more than fans. Sleep under a mosquito net in November and December, when malaria rises after the floods.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask the district administration which river breaks are being sealed, by whom, and by what date (action 1).
- Ask your camp committee or site partner where the agreed high ground is, whether the landowner has agreed in writing, and who will bring you the river warning (action 2).
- Ask WFP and OCHA whether Afgooye is in this Deyr's anticipatory cash plan, as it was in October 2023 (action 3).
- If your family is not on any aid list, give your details to NRC or another cluster partner directly, not to the gatekeeper (action 6).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Seal Afgooye's known weak points and open river breaks with paid local crews by 10 November, and close irrigation cuts by agreement with the farmers

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Afgooye district administration, with local youth crews; FAO and the South West State agriculture ministry advising	10 November 2026; Balgure (Baalguri), Aytire (Aaytir), and Raqeyle first	not costed: FAO's only published Somalia cash-for-work rate is about US$3 a day (2011); envelope carries US$50,000 as a placeholder	a repeat of the 2019–2024 village floods

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

In December 2019, 28 young men in Afgooye sealed four weak sections of the bank, with Balgure the most exposed, and the villages were spared that season (Radio Ergo). It is a local precedent, not a study of deaths: in July 2020 the river overtopped and reached Aytire, and six riverside villages flooded again in September 2024. On 4 October 2026 the national disaster agency, SoDMA, counted 366 high-risk breach points on the Shabelle and named insecurity and decades without maintenance as the causes.

Many breaks are cut by farmers for irrigation and left open. Closing them needs an agreement with the farmers, not just sandbags. Ask FAO's water information unit (SWALIM) or the district for the current list of open points in Afgooye before paying crews; an older figure of about 20 open points could not be re-verified.

Transferability: local precedent from 2019, and FAO and USAID ran sandbag cash-for-work in Lower Shabelle in the 2015 El Niño. Feasibility: Afgooye town and nearby villages are among the few places in the district aid can reach.

2. Relay the upstream river readings at Belet Weyne, Bulo Burti, and Jowhar to every camp and riverside village by 7 November, in Maay and Standard Somali, with high ground agreed in writing

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Site management partners (CCCM: AYUUB and IRDO verified the sites), with SoDMA and the district	**7 November 2026**	**under US$5,000 (estimate: phone credit, loudspeakers, and volunteer time)**	**people trapped by rising water at night**

Afgooye and Balcad have no live river gauge, so the warning has to come from upstream. FAO SWALIM's flood portal publishes daily readings with thresholds: Jowhar moderate risk at 5.00 m and high risk at 5.25 m, Belet Weyne moderate at 6.50 m. On 30 October Jowhar read 4.27 m and Belet Weyne 6.42 m. Each site needs a named elder who receives the warning, a phone tree, and a pre-agreed place on high ground.

The last verified count is 52 sites with 57,753 people (October 2023, up from 30 sites in 2022), and more than 5,000 people arrived after fighting in Basra, Alifow, Baqdaad, and Areer Mooge in August and September 2026 (UNHCR). In the 2024 flood warnings, ringback tones were the channel most warned households heard.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the warning system already exists upstream; what is missing is the last link to each site. The travel time of a flood crest from Jowhar to Afgooye is not published, so treat any rise at Jowhar as the signal to move.

3. Ask WFP, SoDMA, and OCHA by 5 November to keep Afgooye in this Deyr's anticipatory cash plan, as it was in October 2023, and pay each household's own phone

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
WFP, with SoDMA and OCHA (Somalia Humanitarian Fund)	ask by 5 November 2026; cash about 10 days before a forecast flood	about US$267,000 for 3,300 households at WFP's US$81 (estimate: household count assumed)	money arriving after the water

In October 2023 the WFP and SoDMA plan fired for seven districts, Afgooye among them, and paid 218,718 people US$81 per household about 10 days ahead of the forecast flood, funded by Germany. The trigger is a forecast river stage of 4.5–7.5 m on the SWALIM gauges. In April 2024 it fired for four districts only, not Afgooye, and no 2026 activation or district list had been published by 21 October. In WFP's 2024 evaluation, 46% of households that got early cash had acceptable food consumption, against 42% with post-flood aid and 18% with none.

This season's known money goes elsewhere: the UK's £5 million of 23 September names Jowhar and Beletweyne, and SoDMA's list of 29 priority districts, which includes Afgooye, carries no funding. Watch two triggers for scaling cash: the SWALIM gauges, and white maize in Qoryoley rising more than 15% in a month (FEWS NET, monthly). In August maize was 88% above a year earlier even after a good Gu harvest.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: Afgooye has been inside this exact mechanism before. Cash beats food here, because WFP itself went cash-only in April 2026, but part of each transfer pays checkpoint tolls on the roads (XCEPT research), so pair it with action 6.

4. Confirm which cholera treatment unit is open, and stock ORS, zinc, and chlorine with oral rehydration points in the camps by 15 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
South West State Ministry of Health, through the Health Cluster, with WHO and UNICEF supplies	15 November 2026	US$80,000 (placement 1; lens estimate)	child deaths from cholera and diarrhoea after the floods

Afgooye has a recurring cholera burden: a 2021 outbreak began in its camps, cholera kits were pre-positioned there in 2022, and in March 2024 it was named among affected districts in an outbreak of 4,380 cases and 54 deaths, 62% of them children under five (OCHA). UNICEF treated cases in Afgoye in August 2024. No source showed a treatment unit operating there now, so the first step is the Health Cluster's current facility list.

A December 2023 assessment found open defecation at 20 of 27 flood-affected sites in the district; by June 2024 it was 15% of 13 sites. If an outbreak is confirmed, also request oral cholera vaccine through the International Coordinating Group; it protects older children and adults, though not reliably the youngest (see Do not do this).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: ORS evidence is global and strong. The constraint is funding: the 2026 Somalia appeal was about 15% funded in May, and hundreds of health and nutrition facilities closed.

5. Find and treat severely malnourished children: screen with MUAC in every site, keep outpatient treatment running, and top up therapeutic food only on a documented stock-out

CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Nutrition partners (Caafimaad Plus consortium, led by Action Against Hunger, covers Lower Shabelle) under the South West State Ministry of Health	**screening by 15 November 2026; treatment through March 2027**	**US$80,000 top-up, released only on a stock-out (placement 2)**	**deaths of wasted children from disease and heat**

FSNAU's May 2026 district estimates put Afgooye at 15.4% global acute malnutrition and 2.7% severe, a Critical level: about 12,250 severely and 48,430 moderately wasted children among 116,058 under five. In 21 community-based programmes covering 23,511 children, recovery was 79.4% and mortality 4.1% (Collins 2006).

No 2026 pipeline break in therapeutic food (RUTF) was documented, but UNICEF's appeal was under a fifth funded and Red Sea rerouting adds 40–45 days to deliveries. The UK's new £2.5 million to Caafimaad Plus may already cover some sites, so the top-up waits for written confirmation that Afgooye's sites are not funded from it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the treatment model is the national standard. The FSNAU figures are modelled district estimates, not a survey in Afgooye.

6. Count the uncounted: walk the camps formed since September and list the families missing from gatekeepers' lists, and pass the list straight to cluster partners

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Site management partners and NRC, with volunteers who speak Maay	20 November 2026	volunteer time	minority, widowed, and disabled families being left out of every aid round

Camps on the corridor sit on private land run by gatekeepers, who are tied to dominant clans and take a cut of aid, put at 10–15% (EUAA). Minority families, including Bantu farmers displaced from the riverine villages, are the most often left off the lists (The New Humanitarian, Refugees International). UNHCR counted more than 5,000 new arrivals from Basra, Alifow, Baqdaad, and Areer Mooge between 29 August and 13 September 2026, with NRC as its partner.

List widows, people with disabilities, households without a phone, and families from minority groups. Help women register their own SIM cards. Run a complaint line that the gatekeeper does not control.

Transferability: the exclusion pattern is documented for Afgooye and Mogadishu. There is no study of the effect on deaths; it is the precondition for every other action reaching the right people.

7. Give vitamin A to every measles case, and fold catch-up vaccination for children who arrived since April into existing campaigns

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
South West State Ministry of Health, with WHO and UNICEF	30 November 2026	within existing campaign budgets; not separately costed	measles deaths among wasted children

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

One measles dose is about 85% effective, and two or more doses of vitamin A cut measles mortality by 62% (Sudfeld 2010, meta-analyses). In Gode, upstream, measles was part of about one child death in five in the 2000 famine. National campaigns ran in May 2025 and April 2026, so a standalone campaign would duplicate them; the gap is the children who arrived in Afgooye since.

Transferability: strong global evidence. No current Lower Shabelle coverage figure was found.

8. Ring-fence a January–March heat tranche now, for extra water points, roof shading, and daily checks on wasted children, pregnant women, and older people

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
OCHA and the Somalia Humanitarian Fund to commit; site partners and MCH outreach to deliver	commit by 30 November 2026; release 1 January 2027	US$100,000 (placement 4; lens estimate, recipient open)	heat deaths in the forecast February–March peak

The tracker puts 630 of Lower Shabelle's 720 forecast heat deaths in January–March, after the flood money will have been spent. Afgooye's Jilaal heat is humid, with daytime highs of roughly 30–35°C and warm nights; most shelters are buul huts and tarpaulin with no electricity. The roof carries most of the heat into a shelter, and reflective roofs cut indoor peaks by 3–4°C in early, not yet peer-reviewed, results from Ghana and South Africa.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: weak. No study shows that these measures reduce deaths in camps. They are low-regret, and the case for them rests on the timing of the tracker's forecast.

9. Prepare for Rift Valley fever from December: set up surveillance for livestock abortions and tell herders how to protect themselves

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
South West State Ministry of Livestock, with FAO and the Ministry of Health	surveillance in place by 1 December 2026	not costed	human Rift Valley fever deaths after the floods

Rift Valley fever followed the 1997 El Niño floods in southern Somalia from December, and again from December 2006 to February 2007 (114 cases and 51 deaths reported in Somalia; secondary source, not re-verified). In August 2026 IGAD's livestock centre and FAO named Somalia among countries at raised risk. Vaccinating animals would help only before any outbreak, and no vaccine stock or programme in Somalia was found, so surveillance and herder precautions are what is feasible before December.

Transferability: the two-wave pattern is local history, not a tested intervention.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	District administration	SoDMA	SWS Ministry of Health	WHO & UNICEF	Site partners (CCCM)	WFP	OCHA & SHF	FAO	Nutrition partners	NRC	SWS Ministry of Livestock	Elders, mosques & youth
1. Seal known breaks	**A/R**	**C**			**I**			**C**				**R**
2. Warning to every site	**A**	**C**			**R**			**C**				**R**
3. Keep Afgooye in the cash trigger	**I**	**C**			**C**	**A/R**	**C**					
4. Cholera readiness			**A**	**R**	**C**							**I**
5. Treat severe malnutrition			**A**	**R**	**C**				**R**			
6. Count the uncounted	**I**				**A**					**R**		**R**
7. Measles and vitamin A			**A/R**	**R**	**C**							
8. Heat tranche, Jan–Mar			**R**		**R**		**A**					**C**
9. Rift Valley fever watch			**C**					**R**			**A**	**R**

What the chart shows: the South West State Ministry of Health is accountable for three of the nine rows, and the district administration for two. Site partners carry the most responsible roles. Rows 3 and 8 need a decision by a funder rather than new work; row 6 needs nothing but volunteers.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

US$210,000

TARGET

US$577,300

CEILING

US$1.95 million

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

the number of households in Afgooye's camps; the last verified count is from October 2023

Floor = cholera supplies US$80,000 + malnutrition top-up US$80,000 (released only on a stock-out) + crews for river breaks US$50,000 (placeholder) = US$210,000. Target = floor + anticipatory cash for 3,300 households at WFP's published US$81 each (US$267,300; the household count is our assumption) + the heat tranche US$100,000 = US$577,300. Ceiling = two transfers of US$81 to all 10,105 households verified in October 2023 (US$1,637,010) + health and heat US$260,000 + river breaks US$50,000 = US$1,947,010. The target fell from

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

US$718,000 in verification (−20%) because the lens's cash line used a 2020 cost basket; the ceiling rose because the household count doubled since 2022. Costs are in US dollars only; see Money in the methodology.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
WHO or UNICEF cholera supply pipeline, through the South West State Ministry of Health	Action 4: ORS, zinc, chlorine, treatment-unit supplies	US$80,000	pre-positioned stock, released when the Health Cluster names an open facility	Household chlorination about US$53 per DALY (Clasen 2007, modelled for a WHO sub-region)	Partially confirmed
Caafimaad Plus nutrition sites (lead: Action Against Hunger)	Action 5: therapeutic food top-up	US$80,000	top-up, only on a documented stock-out	About US$92 per child recovered at an urban, mostly displaced Somalia site (Stobaugh et al., *Current Developments in Nutrition*, 2022 dollars)	Partially confirmed
WFP and its cooperating partners	Action 3: anticipatory cash to 3,300 households	US$267,300	cash transfer on the river trigger	US$81 per household, WFP October 2023 activation that included Afgooye; acceptable food consumption 46% with early cash vs 18% without (WFP 2024)	Partially confirmed
Recipient open: a site partner with a delivery record	Action 8: January–March heat tranche	US$100,000	second tranche, committed now, released 1 January	No published cost per death averted for heat measures in camps; amount is the lens's estimate	Unverified
Afgooye district administration and local youth crews	Action 1: sealing known river breaks	US$50,000	direct grant for cash-for-work and sandbags	Placeholder; FAO Somalia cash-for-work about US$3 a day (2011). Release after SWALIM or the district lists the breaks, and check that the UK-funded RESTORE programme is not already paying for them	Unverified

The funder's one thing: every El Niño pot traced for this season, the UK's £5 million and the 2023 Somalia Humanitarian Fund allocation before it, went upstream to Jowhar, Beletweyne, and Gedo. Afgooye is 30 km from Mogadishu, so reaching it is not the problem; nobody has picked it up. Commit the January heat money now, because the flood money will be spent before the heat deaths arrive.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice and practice that circulate for floods, cholera, and heat in Somalia and would cost lives or money here. Each was checked by a verifier.

Do not hand out food or cash through camp gatekeepers

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFIER: PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

A confidential UN review dated 7 July 2023 found aid diverted at all 55 displacement sites it examined, and the EU held back food aid funding while it was investigated. Gatekeepers control the lists and take a cut, put at 10–15%, and people who complain risk being evicted. In Afgooye, camp leaders take a share of aid as the condition of entry.

Instead: Verify households directly, pay to each person's own phone, run a complaint line outside the gatekeeper's control, and use third-party monitoring (action 6).

Do not build new earth embankments this season, or rely on sandbag lines alone

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFIER: PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

Sandbags sealed four breaks at Aytire and Balgure in 2019, but in July 2020 the river overtopped and reached Aytire, and the same villages flooded again in 2024. The banks fail because of decades without de-silting and because irrigation cuts are left open.

Instead: Close the known open points (action 1), agree with farmers to close their cuts, and plan to move people out of the riverside villages before the crest.

Do not move displaced families to "safer" plots without the landowner's written agreement

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFIER: CONFIRMED

Evictions from private land are among the most severe protection threats to Somalia's displaced: about 192,000 people were evicted in 2024 (NRC). Most camps around Afgooye sit on private land without formal tenure, so a flood relocation can turn into an eviction.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: Get written landowner agreements for temporary refuge on high ground before the flood (action 2).

Do not count on a single dose of cholera vaccine to protect children under five *

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFIER: PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

Since October 2022 outbreak campaigns have used one dose. In Bangladesh, one dose protected children aged 1 to 4 by about 16%, not significantly, and protection had gone by two years (Qadri, NEJM 2016 and 2018). Even two doses protect under-fives far less than older children (Bi, Lancet ID 2017).

Instead: Put ORS, zinc, and chlorine in place first (action 4). Still request vaccine through the ICG if an outbreak is confirmed, because it protects older children and adults and cuts transmission.

Do not vaccinate livestock against Rift Valley fever once an outbreak has started

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFIER: CONFIRMED

WHO: "Animal immunization must be implemented prior to an outbreak... Once an outbreak has occurred, animal vaccination should not be implemented," because multi-dose vials and reused needles can spread the virus from animal to animal. The 1997 and 2006 outbreaks followed the floods by 6 to 10 weeks, which is when a late vaccination drive would be proposed.

Instead: Surveillance for livestock abortions, and gloves and cooking for herders and families (action 9). *

Do not give heat advice that depends on fans, air conditioning, or grid power *

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFIER: PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

Most people in Afgooye's buul and tarpaulin shelters have no electricity; a site profile recorded none at Barwaqo camp. In humid heat of 30–35°C, fans are not harmful (Morris, Lancet Planetary Health 2021); the reason the advice fails here is that there is nothing to plug them into.

Instead: Shade, covered water, rest at midday, and daily checks on the weakest (action 8 and the For you section).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1961, 1977	Severe Deyr floods on the Shabelle (UNEP/SWALIM flood record)	not recorded for Afgooye	Embankments under the Barre government
1997–98	El Niño Deyr floods on the Juba and Shabelle, then Rift Valley fever from December 1997 (FAO)	about 2,000 dead and 250,000 displaced, southern Somalia	The floods "wiped out even the biggest embankments"; no major rehabilitation since
2006–07	Deyr floods, then Rift Valley fever, December 2006 – February 2007	114 cases and 51 deaths in Somalia (secondary source, not re-verified)	Nothing specific to Afgooye found
2011	Famine declared in Lower Shabelle, 20 July 2011	about 258,000 deaths nationally; about 18% of Lower Shabelle's under-fives died	Cash at scale in 2016–17, when about 3 million people received cash and famine was averted
2019	28 local youths seal four weak sections at Aytire and Balgure (Radio Ergo)	none reported	A local model, never institutionalised
2020	Hagaa-season floods in Afgooye district; the river overtops and reaches Aytire	13,000 displaced	Nothing found
2023	El Niño Deyr floods: Afgooye floods from 4 October; Dhagah Tuur, Bal-Guri, and Raqayle worst hit	118 dead and 1.2 million displaced nationally; more than 28,000 displaced in Afgooye and Mogadishu	WFP anticipatory cash reached Afgooye at US$81 per household
2024	Cholera outbreak (Afgooye named, March); riverine floods in six villages (September)	4,380 cases and 54 deaths nationally, 62% under five; about 1,200 displaced	Afgooye left out of the April 2024 cash trigger

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2026	Fighting displaces more than 5,000 people into Afgooye (Aug–Sep); SoDMA counts 366 breach points (4 Oct); Jowhar passes its high-risk level (17 Oct)	—	Afgooye listed as a priority district, with no funding

The recurrence nobody plans for: twice, in 1997 and 2006, El Niño reached Afgooye in two waves. The river came first, and Rift Valley fever followed in December to February. Everyone plans for the water; the calendar says the animals and the people who herd them are next, and that window opens in about six weeks.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE

UNRESOLVED

- **Pay sandbag crews this week** versus **sandbags only patch the symptom**. The emergency manager, historian, and frontline lenses would pay crews now on the 2019 precedent; the skeptic points to the 2020 overtopping and the irrigation cuts. The report keeps both: seal known breaks and close cuts by agreement, but build no new embankments. A count of open points in Afgooye would settle how much sandbagging can do.
- **Cash is the right tool** versus **cash pays the road tolls**. The economist and historian cite WFP's 2024 evidence for early cash; the food lens finds that checkpoint taxes, not harvest size, set the price of grain on the last 30 km, so cash partly funds the checkpoints. No study measures how much of a transfer is lost this way.
- **Preventive cholera vaccination in the camps** versus **vaccine gives young children false security**. The public health lens would vaccinate; the skeptic warns that one dose barely protects under-fives. The report puts ORS and chlorine first and keeps vaccine for a confirmed outbreak.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

No lens could see the security picture inside the district beyond the town. ACLED logged 976 incidents in Lower Shabelle between April 2025 and March 2026, and most conflict displacement came from Afgooye district itself. Several actions assume that crews, outreach workers, and cash agents can reach the riverside villages; if they cannot, the ranking changes, and warnings and cash by phone move to the top.

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HOW TO READ THIS METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at province level here, Lower Shabelle, not at district scale. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; flood, cholera, malnutrition, and Rift Valley fever are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** Chosen on El Niño Ready's initiative, not from a request: Lower Shabelle has the highest heat burden in Somalia on the Climate Impact Lab tracker, and Afgooye is its flood and displacement corridor. The briefing covers Afgooye town, the riverside villages, and the camps on the Afgooye–Mogadishu road. The tracker resolves Somalia at province level (Shabeellaha Hoose), so no Afgooye-only death figure exists.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): Shabeellaha Hoose, 260 additional heat deaths June–September 2026, 720 forecast October 2026 – March 2027 (October 4, November 47, December 45, January 130, February 230, March 270), 980 in total; Somalia, 6,100; the world, 857,400. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a 1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only; we inferred this from the data, because cold countries show exactly zero in every winter month. They are never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. The Gode briefing, upstream on the same river, was offered as leads only.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.

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- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence, transferability, and feasibility here before the peak. Financial actions were also checked for availability in Somalia, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they already exist; food actions for live price series and delivery modality; the funding envelope for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted in this run. The inventory loads its data in the browser, and every verifier saw an empty list. No action here should be read as having no precedent; none was checked.
- **Money.** Costs are shown in US dollars only. Somalia's federal 2026 budget is set in dollars (US$1.39 billion, passed 23 December 2025), and Mogadishu traders and buses stopped accepting shillings in April 2026; farmers around Afgooye ask for mobile money. The shilling's reference rate (about SOS 570 to the dollar) and its street rate (over SOS 31,000) are so far apart that no conversion would be meaningful. One price is quoted in shillings because the source gave it that way.
- **Reader.** No requester; the briefing was built on El Niño Ready's initiative, so the For you section is written for a resident. Its steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about households here, and each was verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the district, South West State, and their partners.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (oral rehydration salts and water treatment, malnutrition checks, measles and vitamin A, handling sick animals, and heat) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so. Where a cost is an estimate, it says so. Every source is listed below.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Several sources refused direct reads (ReliefWeb pages for the open river points and the 2026 health bulletins; the UNHCR flash alert PDF). There is no Afgooye-specific death toll for any flood, no camp count since October 2023, no current cost basket for Lower

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Shabelle, and no confirmed 2026 status for the anticipatory cash plan. The 1997 Rift Valley fever and 2006–07 figures rest on secondary sources. The locator map shows Afgooye at country scale.

References · Exposure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026); 451,000 at Risk (superseded) · confirmed

River and floods: SWALIM FRRIMS river levels, 30 Oct 2026; SoDMA 366 breach points; 29 priority districts; Jowhar 17 Oct; 2019 youth crews; 2020 overtopping; Sept 2024 assessment; 2023 floods; UNHCR Nov 2023; 2023 national toll; FAO 1998; FAO cash-for-work · partially confirmed

Sites and displacement: CCCM verification Oct 2023; Oct 2022; UNHCR Flash Alert 22; gatekeepers; EUAA; evictions; UN diversion review · partially confirmed

Health: FSNAU prevalence; FSNAU burden; Collins 2006; cholera 2024; WHO EMRO 2021; Munos 2010; Sudfeld 2010; Qadri 2018; Bi 2017; WHO RVF; RVF risk Aug 2026; Morris 2021; HABVIA roofs · partially confirmed

Money and food: WFP Oct 2023 activation; Apr 2024; WFP 2024 evidence; WFP May 2026; UK £5m; ARC payout; 2026 budget; dollarisation; FEWS NET; famine risk; checkpoint taxes; Stobaugh; Radio Ergo schedule · partially confirmed

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 30 October 2026 for Afgooye, Lower Shabelle. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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